

Ipsos Public Affairs



The Ipsos New Zealand Issues Monitor

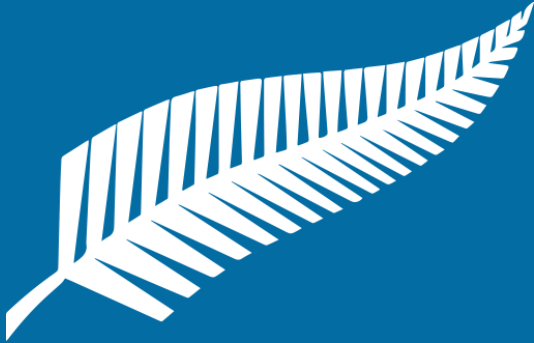
An Ipsos Survey – October 2018

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The Ipsos New Zealand Issues Monitor Survey Overview

Background Information



- At Ipsos, we are passionately curious about people, markets, brands and society. We make our changing world easier and faster to navigate and inspire clients to make smarter decisions. As Ipsos and our previous brands we have been operating in New Zealand since 1992.
- ***This is the third Ipsos New Zealand Issues Monitor report for 2018. The Issues Monitor tracks what New Zealanders are concerned about, who is worried about what, and which political parties are seen to be best able to improve matters.***
- A total of 610 New Zealanders over the age of 18 answered questions for the Ipsos NZ Issues Monitor survey, which ran between 2th and 8th October 2018.
- Please note that the maximum margin of error for a sample of 610 at the 95% confidence level is 4%.
- This study did not have any external sponsors or partners. It was initiated and run by Ipsos, because we are curious about the world we live in and how citizens around the globe think and feel about their world.
- Please direct all queries to Carin Hercock: Phone – 09 538 0500 or Email – carin.hercock@ipsos.com

The Ipsos New Zealand Issues Monitor Survey Overview

The Media Context: What was making New Zealand news in late September / early October?

- The introduction of a new nationwide fuel excise tax on Sunday 30th September saw an additional 3.5 cents added to existing petrol/fuel prices (which led to price variations across the country).
- Prime Minister Jacinda Ardern travelled to the US for a 5-day trip (including visiting the United Nations, appearing on numerous prime-time television shows, delivering the keynote address at opening of UN Climate Week).
- New Zealand celebrated the 125th anniversary of women's suffrage.
- The NZ dollar was trading at its lowest point since early 2016 (US 64.66 cents).
- Statistics NZ reported growth for the June 2018 quarter was 1.0 per cent.
- The New Zealand Educational Institute (primary teachers' union) announced that principals and teachers had voted to reject the coalition government's third pay offer of 3% per year for three years.
- St. John responded to 22 synthetic-drug related call-outs across the country.

Sources for the list above included: www.nzherald.co.nz, www.stuff.co.nz, www.scoop.co.nz, www.odt.co.nz

The Ipsos New Zealand Issues Monitor Survey Overview

Key Findings



Housing remains the most important issue for New Zealanders. **Petrol / fuel prices** now occupy second place, followed by **cost of living, healthcare** and **poverty**.

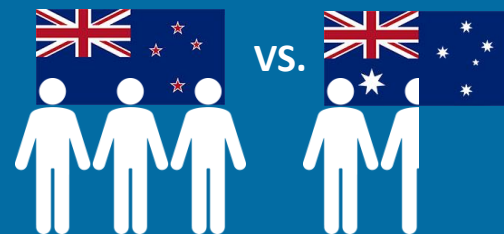


The coalition government continues to enjoy the support of New Zealanders, with an even higher rating than in July 2018.

While Labour has maintained its position as the political party perceived to be most capable of managing *housing, healthcare* and *poverty*, National has made small gains in addressing the *cost of living* and *healthcare*. National is clearly the favoured party for managing *petrol / fuel prices*.



New Zealanders place more importance on *party policies* over having a “leader I prefer”.



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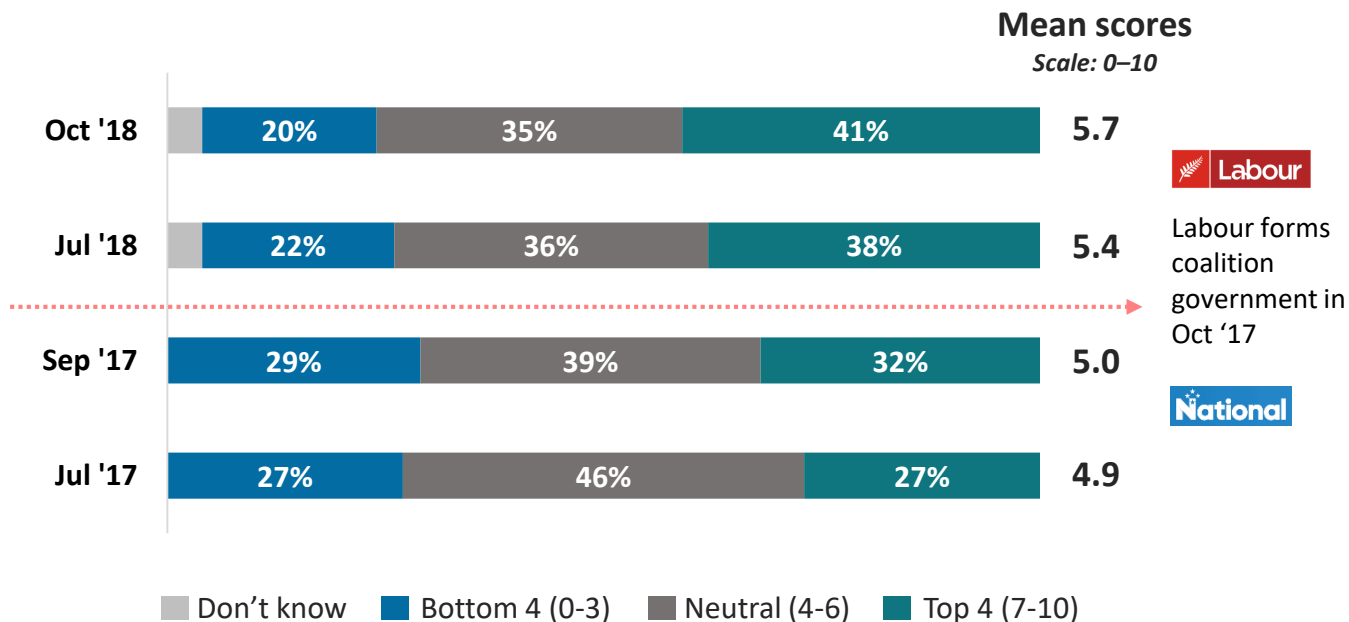
New Zealanders are twice as concerned with *housing* and *petrol / fuel prices* as Australians. Our trans-Tasman neighbours are twice as concerned with *immigration* and *unemployment*.

Perceptions of the coalition government continue to improve compared to Sep '17, when National was in power.

41% of New Zealanders indicated that the coalition government is doing an above-average job in Oct '18 compared to 32% in Sep '17.

Q: Overall, how would you rate the government for its job in the last 6 months from 0 to 10, where 0 means abysmal and 10 means outstanding?

Base: Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Sep '17 (n=500), Jul '17 (n=501)



Concerns about *petrol / fuel prices* have significantly increased since Jul '18.

Housing continues to be the primary issue in the latter part of 2018.

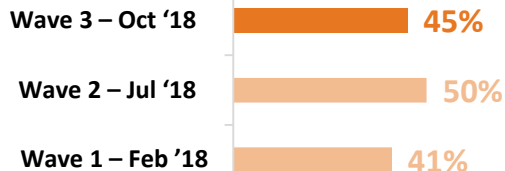
The recent changes in fuel pricing have resulted in a notable 15-point increase in concerns about petrol / fuel prices (up from 16% in Jul '18 to 31% in Oct '18).

Q: What would you say are the three most important issues facing New Zealand today?

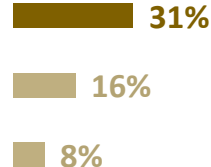
Base: Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)



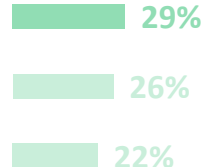
Housing / Price of Housing



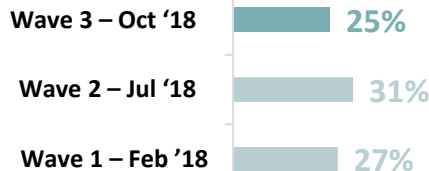
Petrol / Fuel Prices



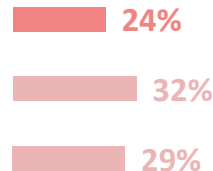
Inflation / Cost of Living



Healthcare / Hospitals



Poverty / Inequality

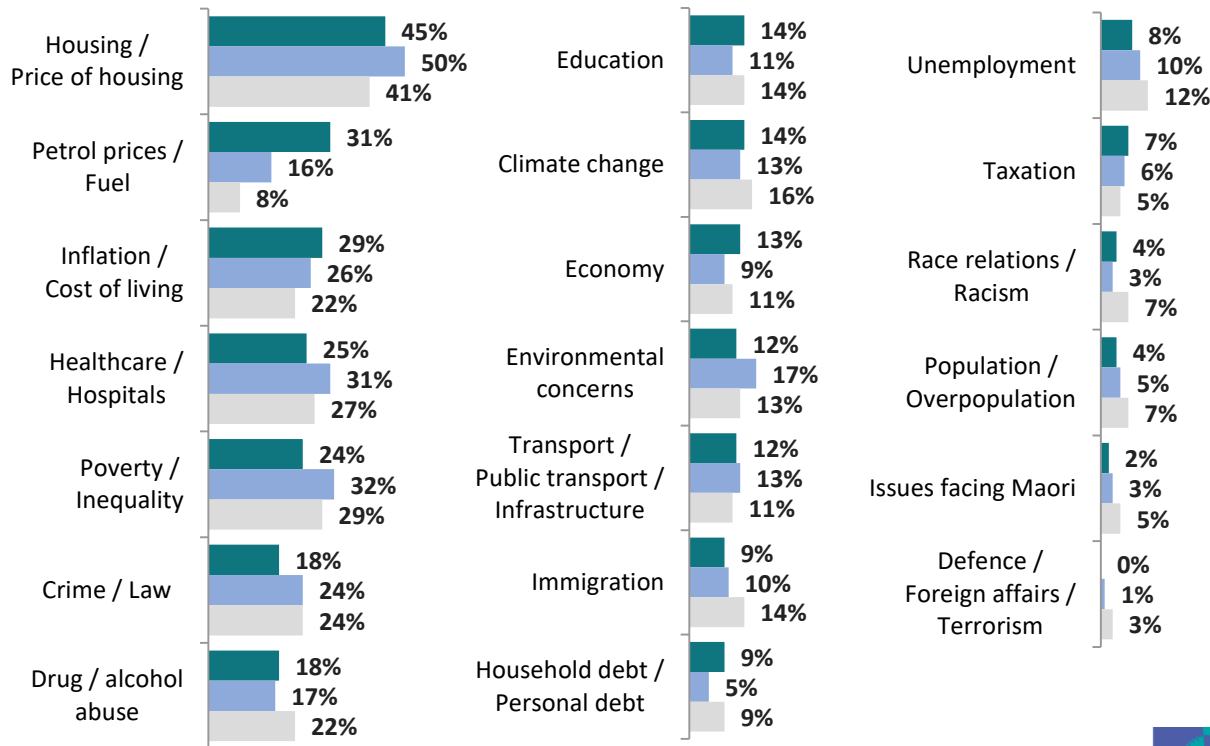
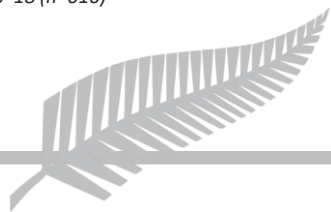


While *housing* is still clearly the number one issue for New Zealanders (45 points), concerns about *petrol / fuel prices* are now the second most pressing issue (31 points).

The *cost of living* has overtaken *healthcare* and *poverty* as the other top issue facing New Zealand in October '18 (29 points).

Q: What would you say are the three most important issues facing New Zealand today?

Base: Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)



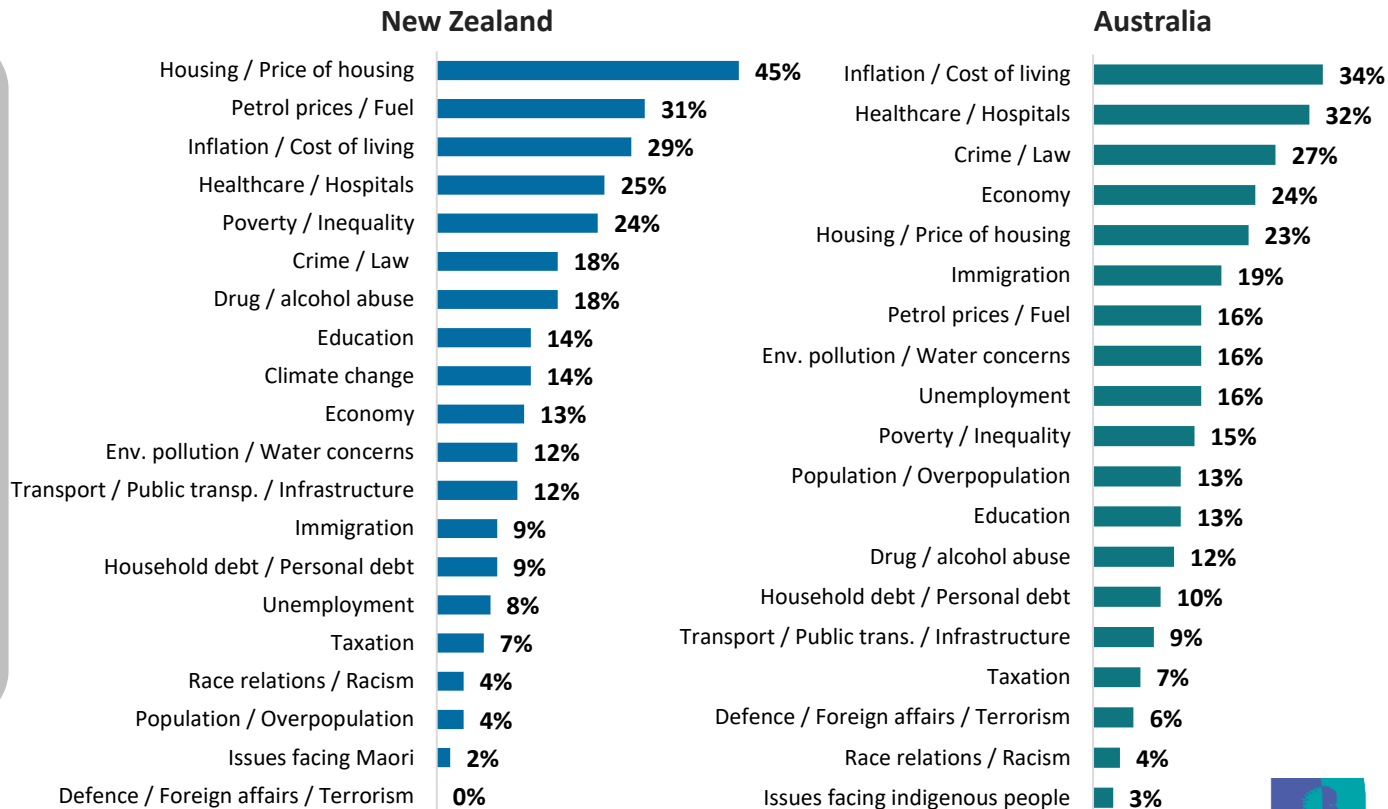
The Oct '18 *NZ Issues Monitor* reveals that New Zealanders & Australians are concerned about different things.

New Zealanders are twice as concerned with housing-related issues and petrol / fuel prices as their Australian counterparts*.

Australians are twice as concerned with immigration and unemployment.

Q: What would you say are the three most important issues facing your country today?

Base: New Zealand (n=610), Australia (n=1,021)



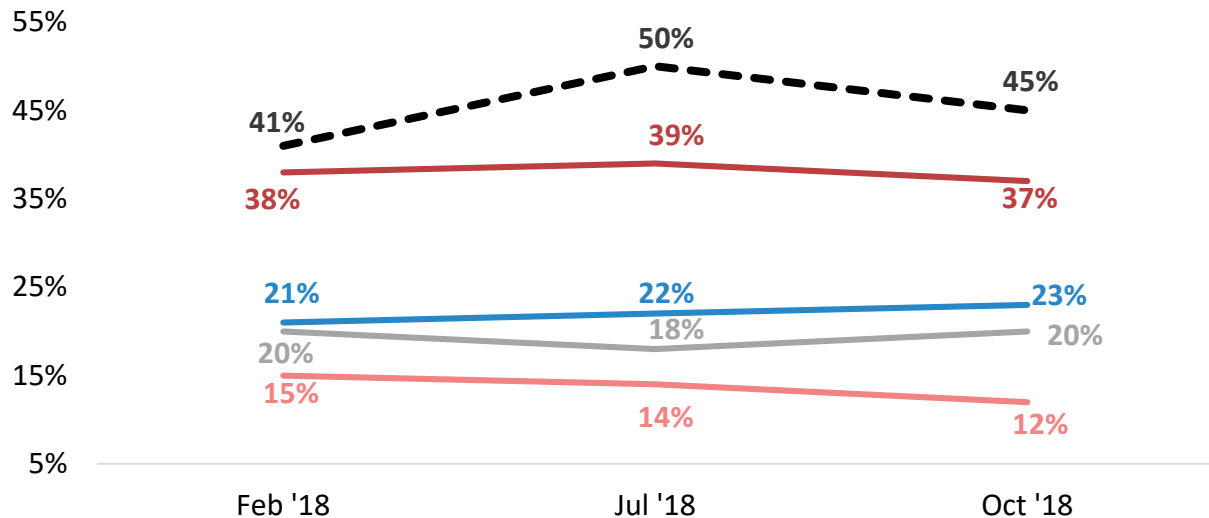
Labour is perceived to be the political party most capable of managing *housing-related* issues in Oct '18.



There has been relatively little change in results across the year in relation to this issue (#1 issue in Oct '18).

Q: Please select the political party that you believe is most capable of managing each of the following issues: Housing

Base: Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)



New Zealand First
Green Party
ACT
Others

2%
2%
1%
1%

4%
1%
1%
1%

4%
2%
1%
1%

--- Housing-related issues (selected as one of the top-3 issues in 2018)

■ Labour ■ National ■ Don't know ■ None

GAME CHANGERS



Suggestions to improve *housing / price of housing* issues

Voice of New Zealanders



Q: What do you think the government needs to change or do differently to improve life in New Zealand? (open-ended question)

Base: Oct '18 (n=610)

***Note:** TAHI = Total Annual Household Income

"Keep addressing the housing issues. Not just build more multi-million dollar properties that nobody can afford, particularly younger people. Need more flats - like blocks of flats that are well-maintained and offer reasonable rent options. Not everyone wants to flat-share in a house with lots of other people. Would be good to have more options for single people who just want a small flat for themselves. Transportation also - could offer different ranges of transport to access other parts of New Zealand, i.e. without a car; it's difficult to get to other parts of the country, so perhaps could be advances in the train or coach systems (like other countries). This would then improve tourism opportunities and provide more work / jobs."

~ Auckland, not in paid employment, TAHI*: \$60k-\$80k

"I think one of the main issues is housing prices and lack of housing in certain areas. Maybe coming up with more affordable housing options would be helpful."

~ Bay of Plenty, full-time employee, TAHI: \$60k-\$80k

"Focus on housing by encouraging non-standard builds, e.g. prefabricated houses, smaller houses, container conversions."

~ Wellington, retired, TAHI: not disclosed

"Take care of our vulnerable children and make housing more affordable to the average person."

~ Wellington, full-time employee, TAHI: \$30k-\$50k

"Stick to the policies they promoted before election. The new 'affordable' housing schemes are a joke, all of the taxes being added to everyday living costs, etc."

~ Canterbury, not in paid employment, TAHI: \$30k-\$50k

"Reduce taxes and lower the pricing of housing or lower regulations for first-home buyers."

~ Canterbury, full-time employee, TAHI: \$100k-\$120k

National has clearly moved ahead of Labour in terms of being the political party most capable of managing *fuel prices*.

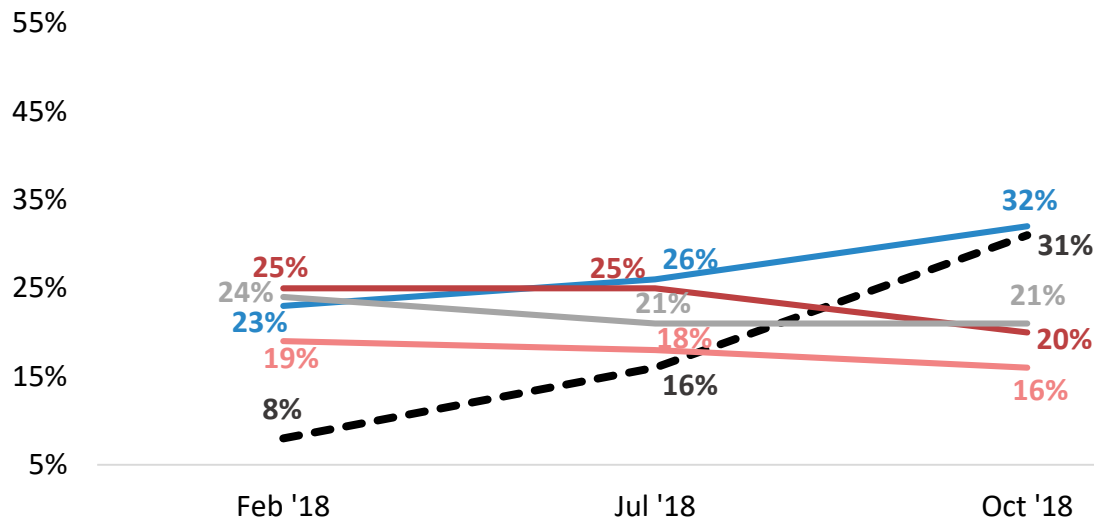


Labour and National were perceived to be quite similar in terms of ability to manage petrol / fuel prices in Feb '18.

Since Jul '18, National has made significant gains over Labour (#2 issue in Oct '18).

Q: Please select the political party that you believe is most capable of managing each of the following issues: Fuel Prices

Base: Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)



New Zealand First
Green Party
ACT
Others

3%
4%
1%
1%

3%
4%
2%
1%

3%
4%
2%
2%

----- Petrol / fuel prices (selected as one of the top-3 issues in 2018)

Labour National Don't know None

GAME CHANGERS



Suggestions to improve *petrol / fuel prices* issues

Voice of New Zealanders



Q: What do you think the government needs to change or do differently to improve life in New Zealand? (open-ended question)

Base: Oct '18 (n=610)

***Note:** TAHI = Total Annual Household Income



"The tax increase for petrol is honestly just ridiculous, we understand it is to improve the public transport system; however, the increase is way too high. Need to keep trying to lower living cost in New Zealand because at this rate and knowing lots of other young New Zealanders including myself, we want to move overseas or somewhere where our wages will match the living cost."

~ Auckland, student, TAHI*: not disclosed

"Stop treating Auckland like a separate entity. Not fair that people in Auckland have to pay a petrol tax for services that most people will not use at all. If this tax was spread across the country it would be less noticeable."

~ Auckland, full-time employment, TAHI: \$80k–\$100k

"Think they need to listen to the needs of people. I think a lot of decisions that are being decided on are ridiculous like petrol tax in Auckland. They are wasting money doing other projects and then put the pressure on taxpayers / residents."

~ Bay of Plenty, full-time employment, TAHI: \$120k–\$140k

"Bring the cost of living down so that people can afford to live; right now everything is so costly that most of us struggle week to week to survive. Cost of petrol also needs to be taken a look at; with all the taxes put on it, it has made things a lot harder for families to be able to get around."

~ Canterbury, retired, TAHI: not disclosed

"Lower taxation on petrol / diesel."

~ Wellington, full-time employee, TAHI: \$60k–\$80k

National & Labour are perceived to be on a par in terms of managing concerns relating to the *cost of living*.

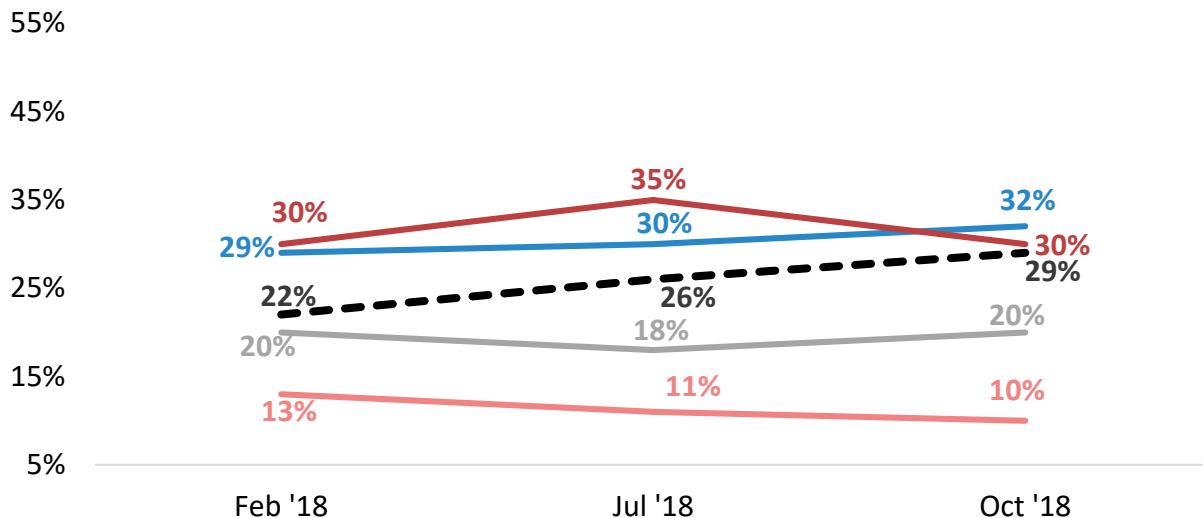


National has managed to close the gap with Labour in Oct '18.

One in five people are unsure of which political party is best positioned to manage this issue (#3 issue in Oct '18).

Q: Please select the political party that you believe is most capable of managing each of the following issues: Inflation / Cost of Living

Base: Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)



New Zealand First

3%

3%

4%

Green Party

2%

1%

1%

ACT

2%

1%

2%

Others

1%

1%

1%

----- Inflation / Cost of living (selected as one of the top-3 issues in 2018)

Labour

National

Don't know

None

GAME CHANGERS



Suggestions to improve *inflation / cost of living* issues

Voice of New Zealanders



Q: What do you think the government needs to change or do differently to improve life in New Zealand? (open-ended question)

Base: Oct '18 (n=610)

***Note:** TAHI = Total Annual Household Income



“Balance cost of living with wages. Nobody working 40+ hours should struggle to pay their bills!”

~ Waikato, not in paid employment, TAHI*: \$60k–\$80k

“Need to make sure that as the cost of living increases, so do people’s wages.”

~ Canterbury, not in paid employment, TAHI: not disclosed

“Give more thought on the economical impact of decisions. Cost of living has just become higher with the fuel price and other decisions.”

~ Auckland, not in paid employment, TAHI: \$60k–\$80k

“Reduce the cost of living. It sucks being in my mid 20s – hardworking, with a massive saving, but still not big enough to buy a house. Hard work does not equal guaranteed security.”

~ Auckland, full-time employee, TAHI: \$50k–\$60k

“Stop so many immigrants coming into our country. Manage to decrease the costs of healthy foods, petrol and housing. Increase minimum wage. Create more apprentice initiatives.”

Canterbury, not in paid employment, TAHI: not disclosed

“Living is so expensive!! Housing and petrol costs are ridiculous!”

~ Bay of Plenty, full-time employee, TAHI: \$50k–\$60k

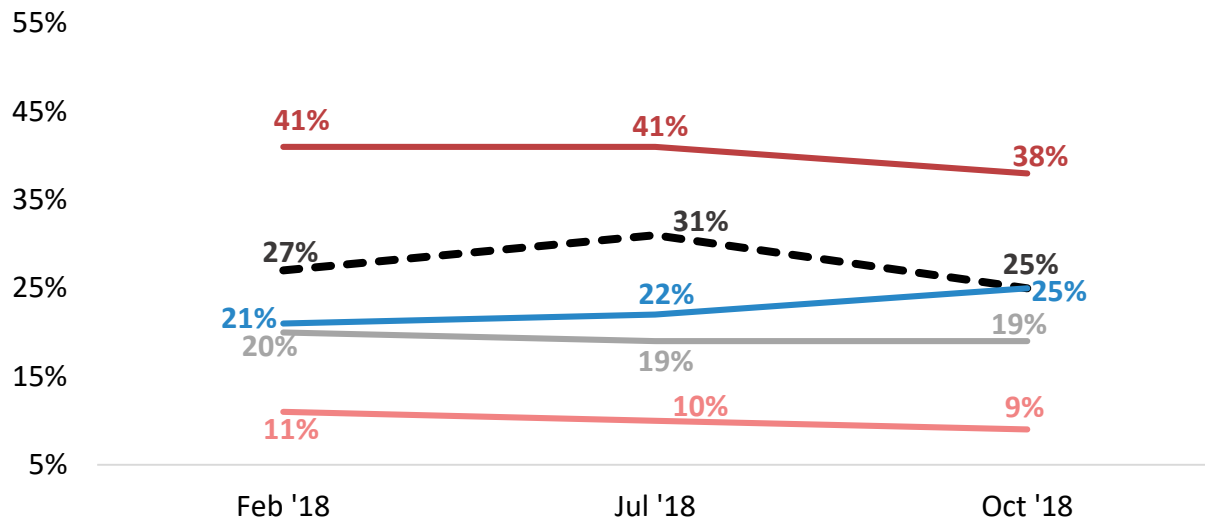
Labour is still perceived as being the most capable political party to deal with *healthcare* issues.



Though Labour is perceived to be the most capable to manage healthcare issues, the 20-point lead over National (Feb '18) has reduced to 7 points (#4 issue in Oct '18).

Q: Please select the political party that you believe is most capable of managing each of the following issues: Healthcare

Base: Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)



New Zealand First
Green Party
ACT
Others

3%
1%
2%
1%

3%
2%
2%
1%

4%
3%
1%
1%

--- Healthcare (selected as one of the top-3 issues in 2018)

Labour National Don't know None

GAME CHANGERS



Suggestions to improve *healthcare / hospital* issues

Voice of New Zealanders



Q: What do you think the government needs to change or do differently to improve life in New Zealand? (open-ended question)

Base: Oct '18 (n=610)

***Note:** TAHI = Total Annual Household Income



"I think mental health needs a serious overhaul which will impact directly on crime. I think we need to focus on young children and helping those who need it the most prior to them being abused or falling through the cracks."

~ Auckland, part-time employee, TAHI*: not disclosed

"I think the current government is trying hard to address the issues with pay for nursing / support staff and the education sector. The purse is only so big - a hard juggling act. I think they need to listen to the people re 1080 ... there have to be other answers. I think they need to legalise cannabis for personal use - particularly for health - would save a lot of gang ownership and money grabbing (in my opinion)."

~ Waikato, part-time employee, TAHI: \$80k-\$100k

"Stop giving away my hard-earned taxes to lazy people and use it for people who seriously need it like hospital waiting lists, education."

~ Hawke's Bay, part-time employee, TAHI: \$15k-\$30k

"More money into hospitals and healthcare. Drop the petrol prices, as it is only going to cause more prices to go up and it won't help inflation. Improve housing and get the homeless off the streets."

~ Hawke's Bay, retired, TAHI: \$15k-\$30k

"Prioritize healthcare, mental health and education and poverty."

~ Auckland, full-time employee, TAHI: \$60k-\$80k

"Reduce immigration, stop refugees until such time as all residents have adequate jobs and housing, stop non-residents from accessing the health system, make it a requirement of at least 20 years' continual residency before getting national superannuation."

~ Auckland, full-time employee, TAHI: not disclosed

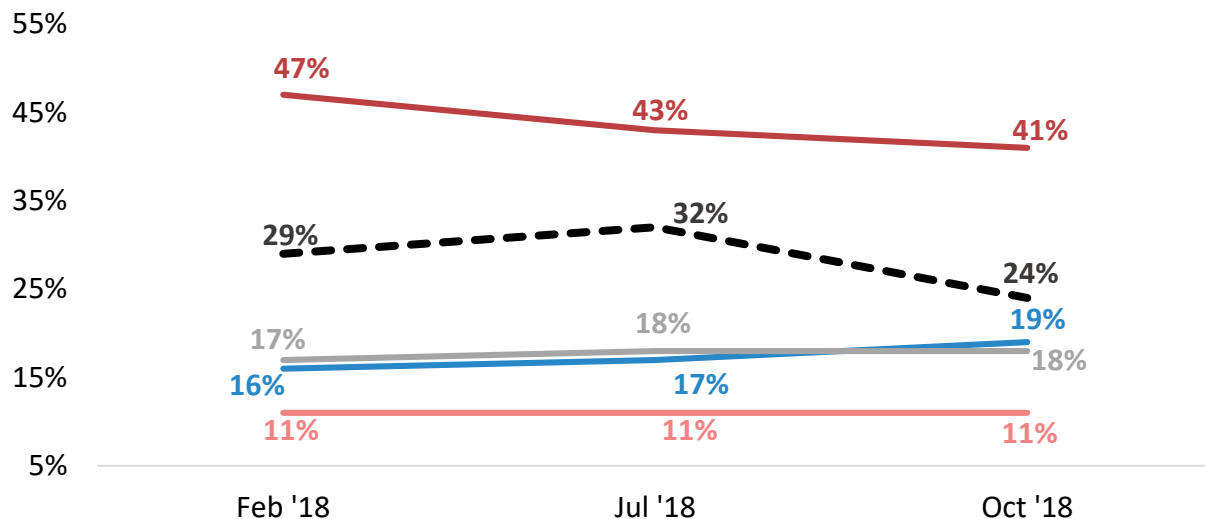
Labour is perceived to be the most capable political party to deal with the issue of *poverty* despite a slight drop since Feb '18.



Although it is clearly ahead of other political parties, the perception of Labour's leading in this area has slightly declined over the year (#5 issue in Oct '18).

Q: Please select the political party that you believe is most capable of managing each of the following issues: Poverty / Inequality

Base: Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)



New Zealand First
Green Party
ACT
Others

3%
3%
2%
1%

5%
3%
2%
1%

4%
3%
3%
1%

----- Poverty / Inequality (selected as one of the top-3 issues in 2018)

Labour National Don't know None

GAME CHANGERS



Suggestions to improve poverty / inequality issues

Voice of New Zealanders



Q: What do you think the government needs to change or do differently to improve life in New Zealand? (open-ended question)

Base: Oct '18 (n=610)

***Note:** TAHI = Total Annual Household Income



“Control inflation and keep the economy growing. Reduce poverty and increase employments and infrastructure, housing affordability, keep control climate change and fuel price.”

~ Auckland, full-time employee, TAHI: \$60k–\$80k*

“Pay equality for female-dominated professions, e.g. education and nursing. Reduce cost of living and encourage more competition between supermarkets and gas companies and electricity providers. Develop sustainable energy sources and reduce use of plastics and packaging. Keep NZ GMO-free.”

~ Auckland, full-time employee, TAHI: not disclosed

“I think poverty and cost of living in NZ really need to be addressed, too many people are now living too difficult an existence and it’s only getting worse.”

~ Waikato, not in paid employment, TAHI: \$15k–\$30k

“Cost of living should be tackled and poverty resulting from illness including mental illness. Environmental issues need to be a huge focus and the education system needs a huge reviewing especially the way tertiary education is offered. Our laws are also very archaic and need to be re-written to represent the findings of modern studies rather than those done in the 60s.”

~ Canterbury, student, TAHI: \$100k–\$120k

“Address how WINZ is run. (I have big personal issues with WINZ, as my interactions with WINZ in Invercargill have made my issues significantly worse, making it harder for me to get on my feet and re-enter the work force). Talk more about foreign investment. There’s a lot of talk about Chinese buying farms / buildings, etc., and running them poorly or just using them as investment properties and driving up prices. Find a way to have more online presence.”

~ Southland, not in paid employment, TAHI: up to \$15k

The top-5 issues are fairly similar for different income groups with varying importance.

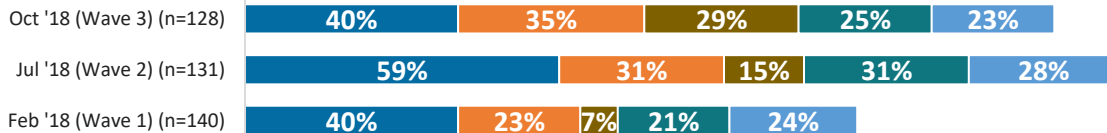
Amongst lower-income households (i.e. those earning under \$30,000), healthcare is the second most important issue. Concern around drug & alcohol abuse has returned to a similar level as it was in February '18.

Q: What would you say are the three most important issues facing New Zealand today?

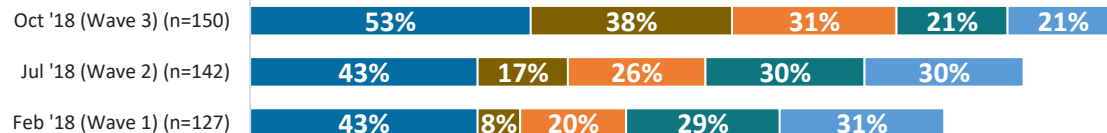
Base: Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)

Note: 320 respondents preferred not to disclose their income (across all three waves).

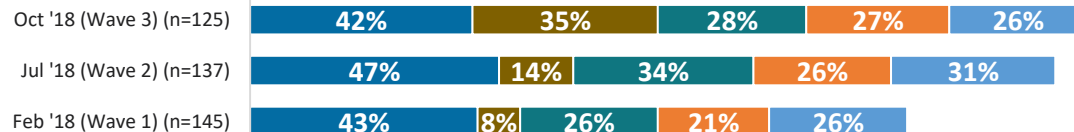
Over \$100,000



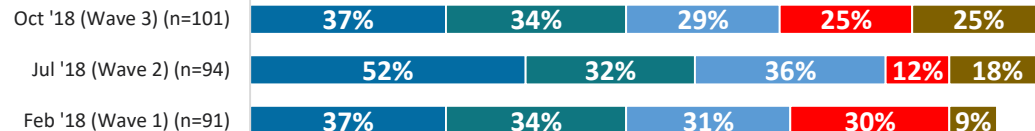
\$60,001–\$100,000



\$30,001–\$60,000



Under \$30,000



Top-5 issues for each group shown

■ Housing ■ Petrol prices / Fuel ■ Inflation / Cost of living ■ Healthcare / Hospitals ■ Poverty / Inequality ■ Drug / Alcohol abuse

GAME CHANGERS



While there is very little difference in the top-2 issues for men & women in Oct '18, *crime / law* appears in the top-5 issues for men.

Women are more concerned with the issue of poverty / inequality than men.

Q: What would you say are the three most important issues facing New Zealand today?

Base: Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)

Note: 9 respondents did not identify as male or female across the three waves.



Men

Oct '18 (Wave 3) (n=287)



Jul '18 (Wave 2) (n=292)



Feb '18 (Wave 1) (n=291)



Women

Oct '18 (Wave 3) (n=318)



Jul '18 (Wave 2) (n=317)



Feb '18 (Wave 1) (n=317)



Top-5 issues
for each group
shown

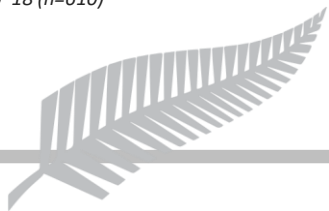
■ Housing ■ Petrol prices / Fuel ■ Inflation / Cost of living ■ Healthcare / Hospitals ■ Poverty / Inequality ■ Crime / Law

New Zealanders aged 55+ years have become even more concerned about *petrol / fuel prices* since mid-2018.

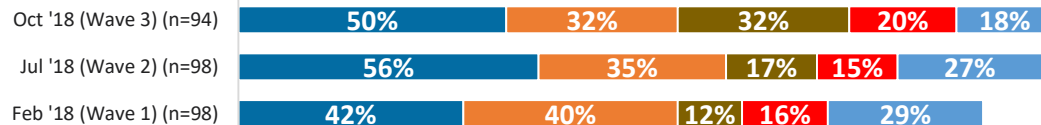
Healthcare continues to be another top-of-mind issue for older New Zealanders, though there has been a moderate drop compared to July '18.

Q: What would you say are the three most important issues facing New Zealand today?

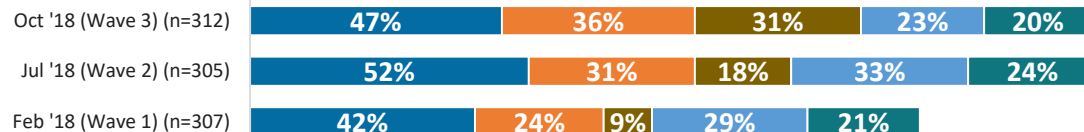
Base: Oct '18 (n=610), Jul '18 (n=611), Feb '18 (n=610)



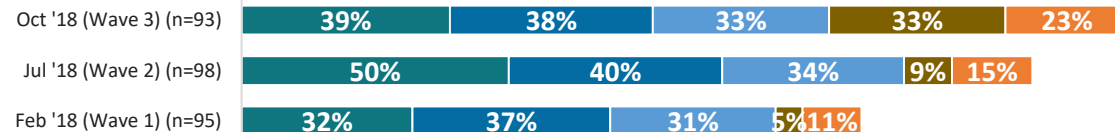
18–24 years old



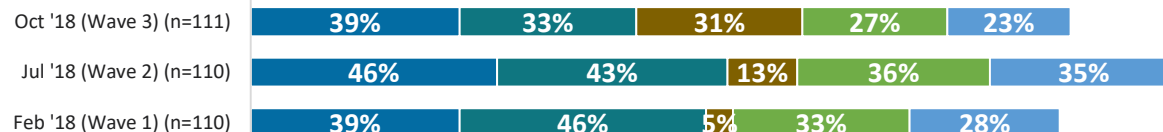
25–54 years old



55–64 years old



65+ years old



Top-5 issues for each group shown



GAME CHANGERS



New Zealanders place more importance on *party policies* over having a “leader I prefer”.

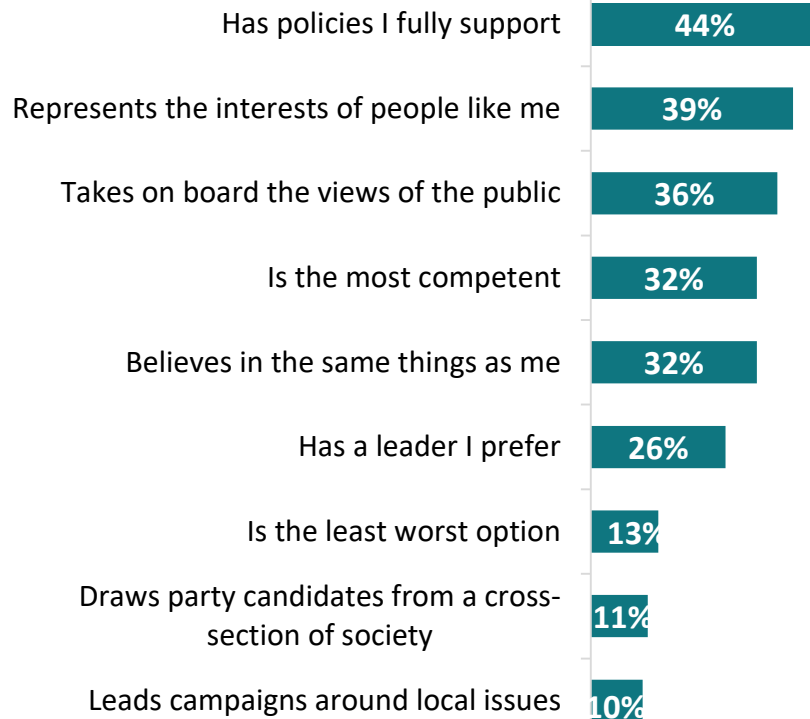
New Zealanders prefer political parties who are able to offer personally attractive or relevant policies.

The abilities to represent the interests of voters and acknowledge the public's views are also important.

*Q: Thinking generally, which two or three of these, if any, are usually most important to you in deciding which political party to vote for?**

Base: Oct '18 (n=610)

Note: Only responses 10% and above have been reported for this question.



Representing the interests of “people like me” & taking on board the wider public’s views are more important to women.

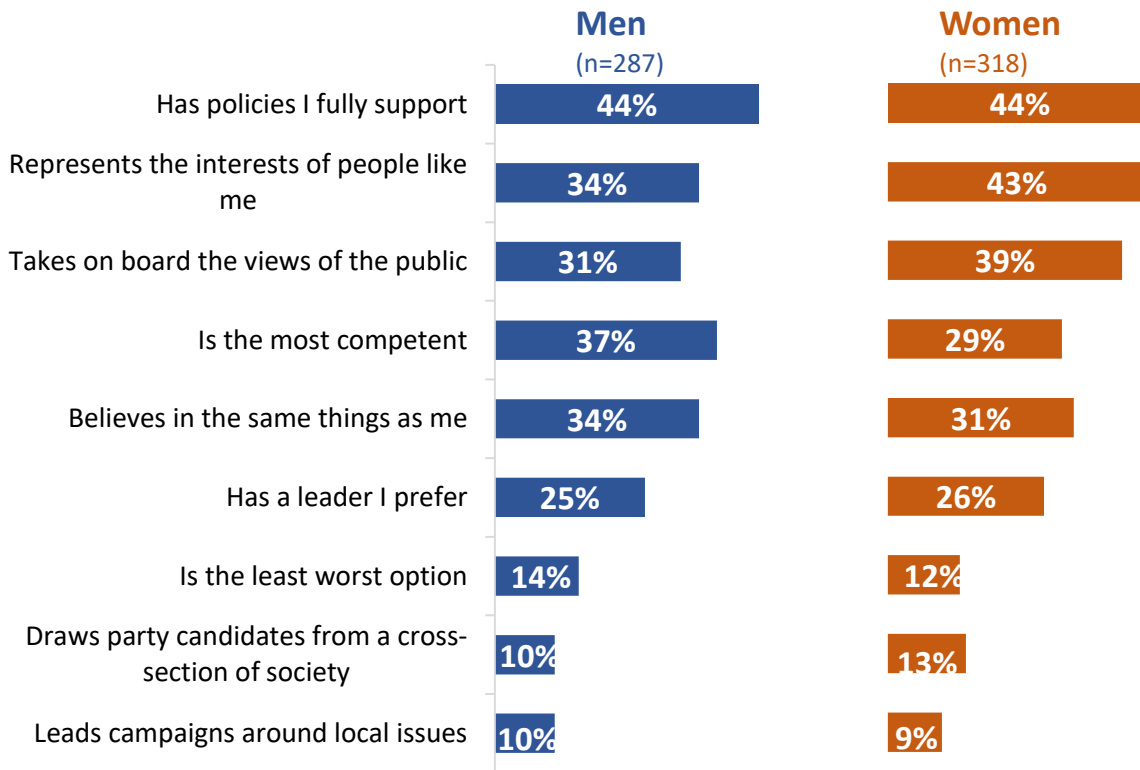
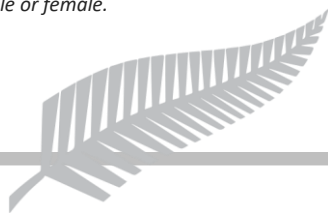
Men are likely to place more importance on the competence of a political party compared to women.

Q: Thinking generally, which two or three of these, if any, are usually most important to you in deciding which political party to vote for?

Base: Oct '18 (n=610)

Note 1: Attributes arranged in descending order based on the total sample.

Note 2: 5 respondents did not identify as male or female.



Although those aged 18–24 are less concerned with *competency*, they also place high value on *policies they fully support*.

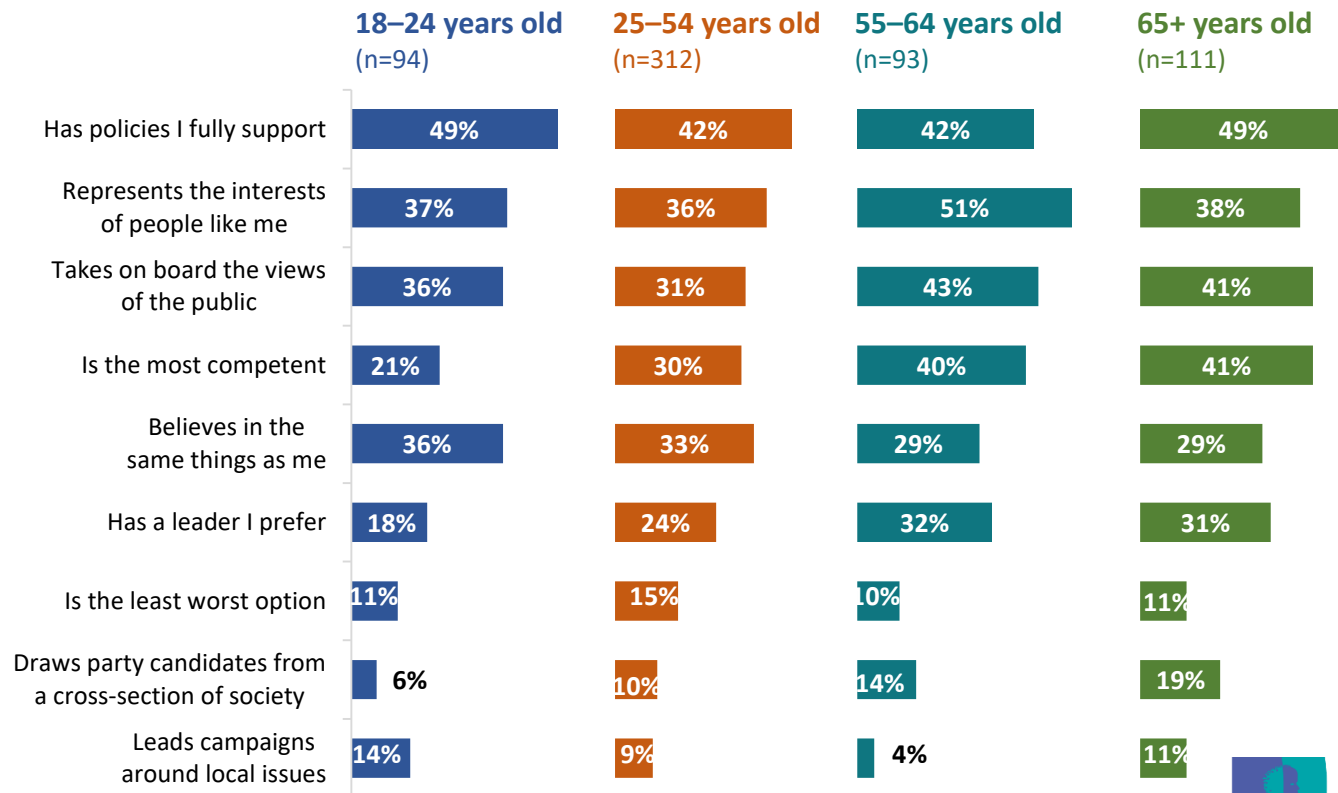
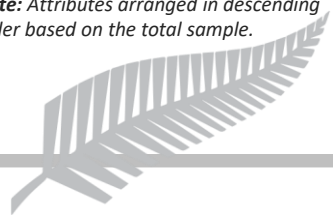
The importance placed on competence and who is leading a political party tends to increase with age.

Encouragingly, all age groups tend to avoid the “least worst option” in their political decision-making process.

Q: Thinking generally, which two or three of these, if any, are usually most important to you in deciding which political party to vote for?

Base: Oct '18 (n=610)

Note: Attributes arranged in descending order based on the total sample.



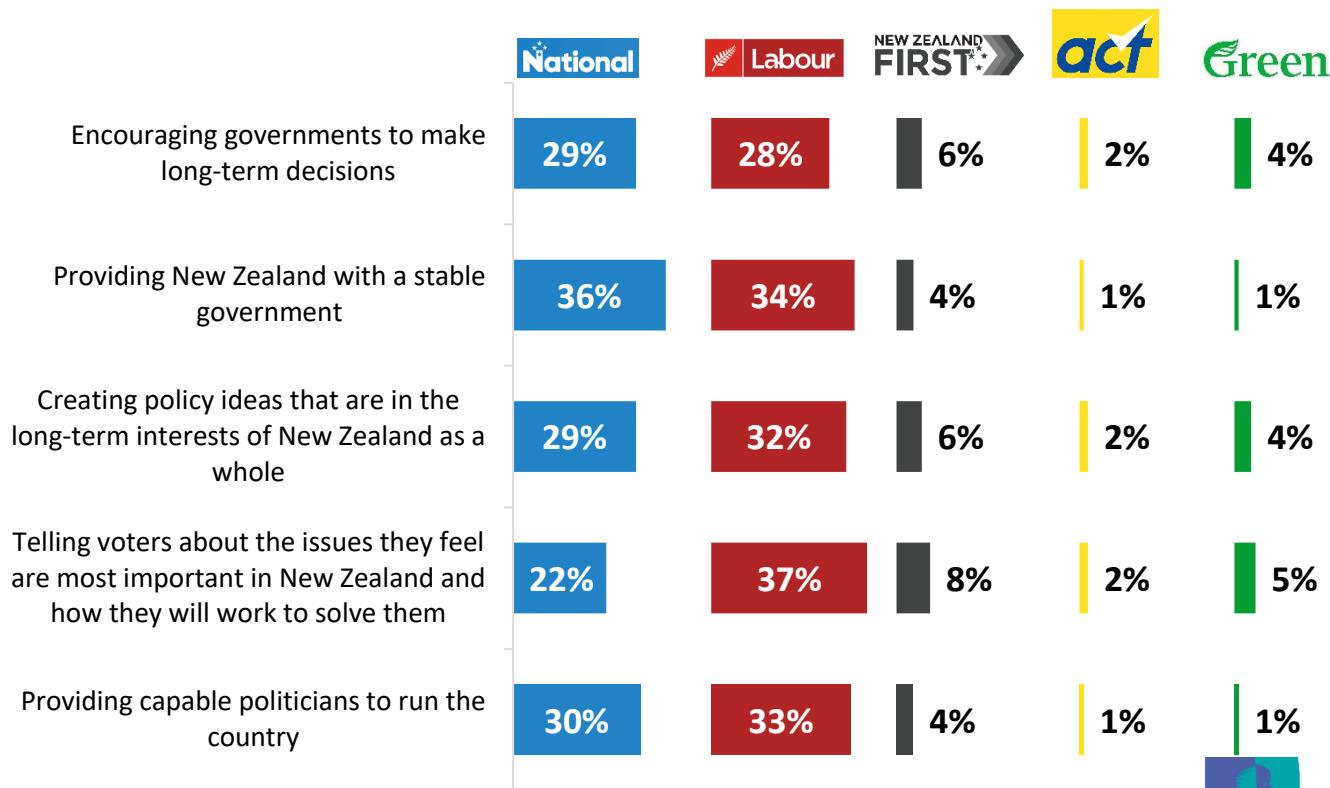
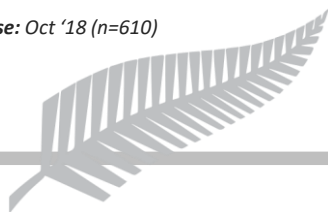
Labour is perceived to be better at *communicating issues they feel are important* & *how to find potential solutions for these* – other Oct '18 NZ Issues Monitor results further reinforce this key finding.

Notably, Labour and National are equally viewed as having the ability to provide the country with a stable government and politicians who are both capable and able to run New Zealand.

The minor parties did not break the 10-point threshold on any of these attributes.

Q: Thinking about the role of political parties more specifically, please select the political party you associate most with the different attributes provided below

Base: Oct '18 (n=610)



Sample demographics – Oct '18



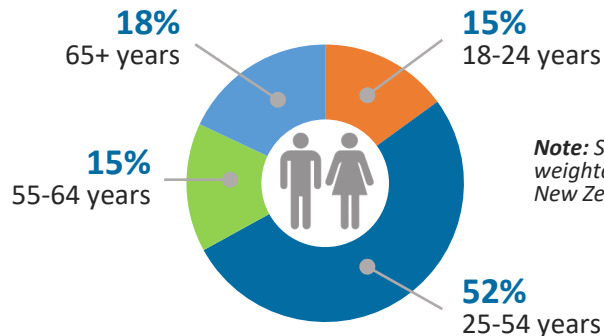
610 respondents

were interviewed online in Oct '18 using the SSI online panel



Note: 1% gender diverse

The maximum margin of error for a sample of 610 at the 95% confidence level is 4%



Note: Sample has been weighted to reflect the New Zealand population.



Employment status

40% Full-time 7% Self-employed
19% Retired 7% Not in paid work & not seeking work
14% Part-time 5% Not in paid work but seeking work
8% Student



Highest education completed

3% Primary education
29% Secondary education
25% Post-secondary non-tertiary education
31% Undergraduate university degree
12% Post-graduate university degree



Type of area live in

44% In the suburbs of a large city
16% In, or right outside, a medium sized city
15% In a rural area
14% In a large city
10% In, or right outside, a small city

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